❷ Elements common to every page, such as your CSS, are typically found in the layout.

❸ Tells the templating engine where to insert the child view's content

As you can see, the layout file includes the required elements, such as `<html>` and `<head>`, as well as elements you need on every page, such as `<title>` and `<link>`. This example also shows the benefit of storing the page title in `ViewData`; the layout can render it in the `<title>` element so that it shows in the browser's tab, as shown in figure 17.11.

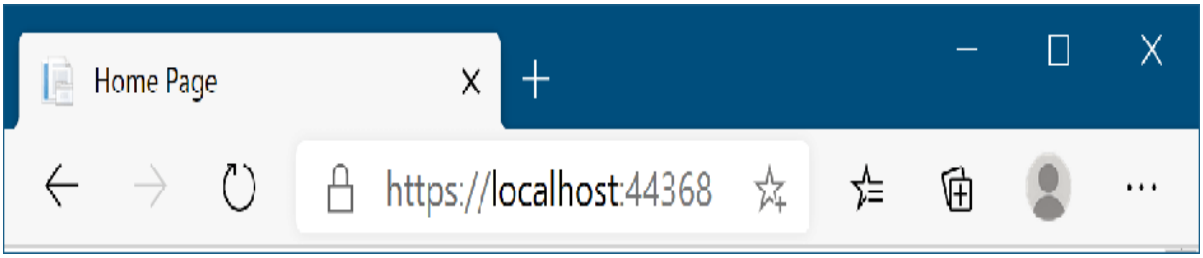


Figure 17.11 The content of the `<title>` element is used to name the tab in the user's browser, in this case Home Page.

NOTE Layout files are not standalone Razor Pages and do not take part in routing, so they do not start with the `@page` directive.

Views can specify a layout file to use by setting the `Layout` property inside a Razor code block, as shown in the following listing.

Listing 17.8 Setting the `Layout` property from a view

```
@{
    Layout = "_Layout";                ❶
    ViewData["Title"] = "Home Page";   ❷
}
<h1>@ViewData["Title"]</h1>            ❸
<p>This is the home page</p>           ❸
```

❶ Sets the layout for the page to _Layout.cshtml

❷ ViewData is a convenient way of passing data from a Razor view to the layout.